AVO-RFP-2026-017 / ISSUED 02 NOVEMBER 2026

# Request for Proposal

## Customer Operations Knowledge Platform

**Fictional buyer:** Aster Vale Operations (AVO)
**Document owner:** Procurement & Customer Operations

**SYNTHETIC TEST DOCUMENT.** All organizations, requirements, dates and amounts in this RFP are invented for software testing. This is not a live solicitation, an offer, or a statement of any supplier's capabilities.

### 01 / Business objective

AVO seeks a searchable, governed knowledge platform for its customer operations teams. The program should reduce time spent locating approved answers, preserve source references, and replace uncontrolled copies of operational documents.

The planning baseline is **180 named users** across three regional offices, including 30 supervisors, and approximately **12,500 source documents / 60 GB**. The source inventory and access groups must be validated during discovery.

| Procurement event | Date / constraint |
|---|---|
| Supplier questions due | 16 November 2026, 17:00 UTC |
| Proposal submission deadline | **04 December 2026, 17:00 UTC** |
| Shortlisted demonstrations | Week commencing 11 January 2027 |
| Target contract award | 15 February 2027 |
| Target kickoff / production | 01 March 2027 / 05 July 2027 |

**First-year ceiling:** USD 180,000 excluding taxes, inclusive of implementation, migration, training and year-one subscriptions. Detailed pricing rules are on page 5.

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL / SECTION 02

# Functional scope

**M = mandatory; D = desirable.** For every requirement, provide a response status, supporting evidence and any dependency or exception. Desirable features do not substitute for mandatory controls.

| ID | Class | Requirement / requested evidence |
|---|---|---|
| F-01 | M | Support 180 named users with separate reader, editor and administrator roles. Demonstrate that restricted regional content is not visible to unauthorized users. |
| F-02 | M | Migrate approximately 12,500 documents / 60 GB, including text-based PDFs, while preserving document owners, effective dates, source IDs and access classifications. Describe deduplication and exception handling. |
| F-03 | M | Provide keyword and semantic search with filters for region, topic, owner and effective date. Generated answers must cite the source document and page where available. |
| F-04 | M | Integrate with the buyer's corporate identity provider using SAML 2.0 or OpenID Connect. Enforce role changes and deactivation within 60 minutes. |
| F-05 | M | Maintain approved document versions and export content, metadata and access classifications in documented, non-proprietary formats. |
| F-06 | D | Offer English and Korean search and interface support. Clearly distinguish capabilities available at launch from roadmap items. |
| F-07 | D | Provide aggregate usage and unanswered-query reporting without exposing restricted document text to unauthorized supervisors. |

## Scope boundaries

The base proposal covers internal staff only. Public customer access, scanned-document OCR, custom mobile applications and automated changes to source systems are excluded. Quote any such extensions separately and do not include them in the base commitment.

## Customer dependencies

AVO will nominate content owners and supply a representative document inventory. The final taxonomy, identity-provider connection details and legacy export schedule will be agreed in discovery; suppliers must state their assumptions.

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL / SECTION 03

# Security & data governance

Mandatory controls require evidence, not a general statement of compliance. Disclose subcontractors and identify which party operates each control.

| ID | Class | Requirement / requested evidence |
|---|---|---|
| S-01 | M | Keep production content, derived indexes and backups within the EU/EEA. List proposed hosting and backup locations and all subprocessors. |
| S-02 | M | Encrypt data in transit using TLS 1.2 or later and at rest using AES-256 or equivalent. Explain key ownership, rotation and privileged access. |
| S-03 | M | Retain searchable audit events for at least 13 months. Include sign-ins, permission changes, exports and administrative actions; support a scoped CSV export. |
| S-04 | M | Provide either a current ISO 27001 certificate or a SOC 2 Type II report covering the proposed service. SOC 2 Type I alone is not sufficient. Explain any scope limitations and how restricted evidence will be reviewed. |
| S-05 | M | Notify AVO within 24 hours after confirming a security incident affecting buyer data. Supply an escalation process and a sample incident-report template. |
| S-06 | M | Do not use buyer content, prompts or generated answers to train shared models. Provide contractual terms covering model providers, retention and deletion. |
| S-07 | D | Support customer-managed encryption keys. Identify added cost and any feature limitations; this is desirable, not a mandatory eligibility condition. |

### Exit and deletion

Provide a complete content and metadata export within 30 calendar days of an approved exit request. Delete primary copies within 45 days after export approval and provide written confirmation. The backup-expiry schedule must be proposed and agreed before award.

**Evidence boundary:** This RFP defines the buyer's requirements. It contains no supplier certificate, audit report or signed data-processing commitment. A requirement is not evidence that a particular supplier satisfies it.

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# Delivery, service & acceptance

Propose an **18-week implementation** from the target kickoff of 01 March 2027, aiming for production readiness on 05 July 2027. This is a buyer target, not evidence of supplier availability or a confirmed commitment.

| Phase | Weeks | Expected deliverables |
|---|---|---|
| Discover | 1-3 | Validated inventory, access model, agreed taxonomy and acceptance plan. |
| Configure | 4-8 | Configured workspaces, identity integration and security design. |
| Migrate & test | 9-14 | Reconciled imports, load/security tests and administrator runbook. |
| Pilot & handover | 15-18 | 30-user pilot, acceptance evidence, training and support handover. |

## Acceptance requirements

| ID | Acceptance condition |
|---|---|
| A-01 | At least 99.5% of in-scope files pass the agreed migration integrity checks; 100% of restricted-content access test cases pass. |
| A-02 | At least 85% of 30 buyer-approved test queries return a relevant source in the top three results. Assessors also check source/page references. |
| A-03 | 95th-percentile search response is under 4 seconds during an agreed load test with 180 concurrent users. State the proposed test method. |
| A-04 | Complete 10 business days of user acceptance testing with no unresolved critical or high-severity defects; agree severity definitions in discovery. |
| A-05 | Deliver two administrator workshops, four end-user sessions, recordings and a usable operations/exit runbook before handover. |

## Requested service levels

**Availability:** 99.9% per calendar month, excluding agreed planned maintenance of at most four hours with 48 hours' notice. **Recovery:** RTO 4 hours; RPO 1 hour. **Priority 1:** 24x7 coverage, 15-minute acknowledgement, 4-hour workaround target. **Priority 2:** 4-business-hour acknowledgement, Monday-Friday 09:00-17:00 UTC.

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL / SECTION 05

# Commercials & evaluation

## Commercial response

The **maximum base first-year price is USD 180,000 excluding taxes**. It must include setup, migration, implementation services, training, support and year-one subscriptions for 180 named users. Identify all volume assumptions and overage rates. Options must be itemized separately, not hidden in the base scope.

Provide separate prices for years 1, 2 and 3, renewal uplift rules, termination charges and exit/export assistance. AVO's **year-two renewal target is USD 90,000**; this is a planning target, not an additional mandatory price cap.

Proposals must remain valid for 120 calendar days after the submission deadline. Propose milestone-based payment terms; final terms remain subject to negotiation. No supplier prices, discounts or staffing rates are supplied in this document.

## Mandatory eligibility gate

Before weighted scoring, AVO reviews every mandatory requirement on pages 2-4, the first-year price ceiling and response completeness. Mark exceptions explicitly. An unsupported compliance claim is not a pass; the buyer may request clarification or reject a proposal that does not meet a mandatory condition.

| Scored criterion | Weight | Evidence considered |
|---|---|---|
| Functional fit | 30% | Demonstration, requirements mapping, migration and source citations. |
| Security & governance | 25% | Control evidence, certification/report scope, data handling. |
| Delivery & adoption | 20% | Milestones, staffing assumptions, acceptance and training plan. |
| Three-year commercial value | 15% | Transparent base price, renewals, overages and exit costs. |
| Support & service | 10% | Service model, recovery approach, escalation and references. |
| TOTAL | 100% | Weighted scoring follows the mandatory eligibility gate. |

**No award promise.** AVO may amend or cancel this fictional process. The lowest price is not automatically the highest-scoring proposal. Dates, prices and evaluation weights are synthetic test data.

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL / SECTION 06

# Response instructions & open items

## Required response package

Submit a concise executive summary, a requirement-by-requirement matrix, a proposed architecture and data-flow description, an implementation plan, a three-year price schedule and a security evidence register. Use the requirement IDs in this RFP.

For each mandatory item, state **Meets / Partially meets / Does not meet**, cite evidence and explain exceptions. Separate existing product features from proposed custom work and future roadmap items. Identify accountable delivery and support roles.

Provide two comparable customer references with permission to share their details. Identify assumptions, buyer dependencies and exclusions. Do not present unverified supplier claims as completed due diligence.

## Clarifications required before a binding commitment

| Open item | Buyer information still to be agreed |
|---|---|
| Migration inventory | Final document count, duplicate rate, unreadable files and access labels. |
| Identity integration | Identity-provider configuration, test tenant and deactivation workflow. |
| Service boundaries | Final support severity definitions and planned-maintenance windows. |
| Data lifecycle | Backup-expiry schedule and the approved process for exit/deletion evidence. |
| Delivery dependencies | Content-owner availability, legacy export dates and pilot participants. |

## Submission and questions

**Deadline:** 04 December 2026, 17:00 UTC.
**Fictional contact:** rfp@astervale.example
This reserved example-domain address is a placeholder. Do not send a real proposal or attempt to contact anyone; this file is only for local application testing.

**Supplier evidence intentionally absent.** No supplier identity, certifications, references, rates, confirmed staff or delivery commitments are attached. A draft response should label these gaps **Needs confirmation** and distinguish a suggested approach from facts established by this RFP.